

2.2 Content

Reading

Students should spend approximately 52 minutes of the 1-hour and 45-minute exam on this section, which is worth 50% of the paper and 25% of the qualification. It consists of 40 marks.

This section will consist of five tasks, each based on a collection of short texts or a longer single text.

The literary text consists of a short extract from a text that may have been adapted and abridged from authentic sources to be appropriate to this level – from letters, short stories, novels or plays to contemporary and historical sources.

Students will be required to read a range of authentic factual and non-factual written material of varying length, in different registers and contexts, and from different sources. These may include advertisements, short passages, letters, information leaflets, faxes, emails, website pages, newspaper and magazine articles and literary texts.

Stimuli and tasks will always be contextualised and, where appropriate, a purpose for the task will be identified.

The topics of the stimulus texts will be taken from a range of situations, from both everyday life and academic contexts with which students will be familiar. A different task type may be used with each stimulus text.

The questions will require a combination of non-verbal responses and answers in French. In order to answer the questions, students will need to use a range of reading techniques such as skimming, scanning and in-depth reading for details. Grammatical accuracy will not be assessed in this section of the paper.

Correct spelling will not be a requirement as long as the student's response is comprehensible.

Task types demand a variety of input from students and include multiple-choice, multiple-matching, note-taking, table-completion, gap-fill and short-answer questions.

Writing

Students should spend approximately 52 minutes of the 1-hour and 45-minute exam on this section, which is worth 50% of the paper and 25% of the qualification. It consists of 40 marks.

This section will consist of two writing tasks and a third grammar-based task.

The first writing task is short, and the student will be asked to write 60–75 words, including four prescribed words or short phrases.

The second writing task is longer than the first and contains an element of choice. The student will be able to choose from three questions that are drawn from different topics, and they will need to write between 130 and 150 words in response to the question, addressing four bullet points.

In the third grammar-based task students will be asked to change the words in brackets so that they correctly fit the sentences. This will involve the need to manipulate, for example, verbs and adjectives, into their correct word form.

Grammatical accuracy, punctuation and spelling will be assessed in this section of the paper.
